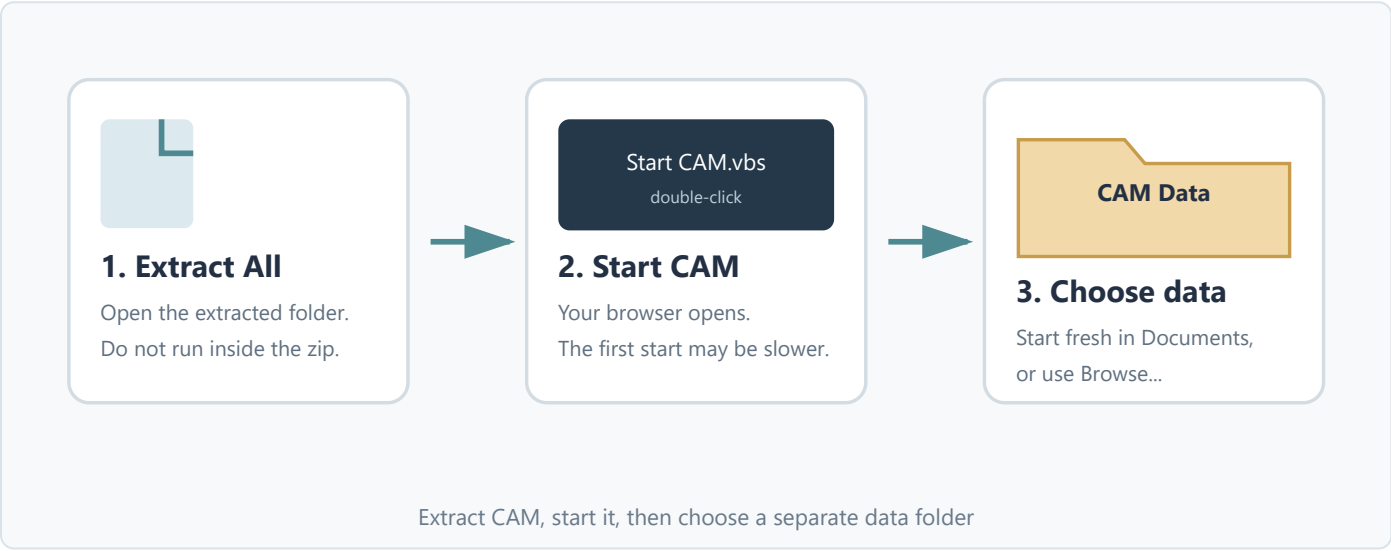
TASK 1 OF 8

Get started on Windows

1. Right-click the downloaded CAM zip, choose **Extract All**, and open the new folder. Don't run CAM from inside the zip — it can't save anything there.
2. Double-click **Start CAM.vbs**. Your browser opens by itself; the very first start takes a little longer.
3. The welcome screen asks where your gradebook should live — you answer once per computer:

- Already have a CAM gradebook? CAM looks through your OneDrive / Google Drive / Dropbox folders and lists what it finds — click **Use this** beside yours (the class and student counts help you recognise it).
- Want a particular folder — a USB drive, a network share, a new cloud folder? Click 📁 **Browse...**, pick it, then **Use this folder**.
- New to CAM? Click **Start fresh with sample data** and your gradebook is created in `Documents\CAM Data`.



Extract CAM, start it, then choose a separate data folder

Good to know

- The app folder and your data folder are deliberately separate: to update CAM you just replace the app folder, and your gradebook is untouched.
- A cloud-synced data folder (OneDrive / Google Drive) means every computer you use shares the same gradebook — and it's backed up without you doing anything.
- The sample class is entirely fictional, so explore freely — nothing you try can affect real students.

> Choosing a folder never overwrites anything: an existing database there is loaded, and an empty folder simply gets a new one on first save.

TASK 2 OF 8

Get started on a Mac

Use the Apple Silicon ZIP on a Mac with an Apple chip and macOS 14 (Sonoma) or newer.

1. Open the ZIP in Finder, then move **CAM.app** to **Applications**.
2. Try opening CAM. If macOS blocks a trusted first download, open **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → **Open Anyway**. Apple's first-launch steps
3. In the browser, choose your existing gradebook with **Browse…** or choose **Start fresh with sample data** to try the fictional class in `~/Documents/CAM Data`.
4. Click **Quit CAM** beside **Settings** to stop CAM and its grading helpers.

When updating

Replace **CAM.app** in **Applications** and keep your data folder separately. CAM keeps settings and `cam.log` in `~/Library/Application Support/CAM`.

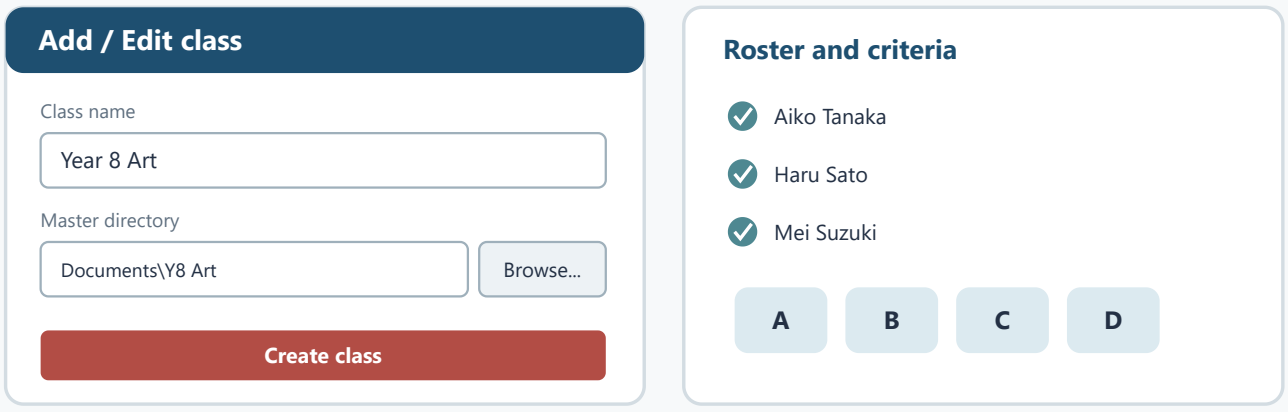
> Back up the gradebook and class exam folders. Update every computer that uses the shared folder before opening an existing exam.

TASK 3 OF 8

Set up a class

CAM lays the whole job out in three windows, read left to right in the order you work: **Window 1 · Assignments and Exams**, **Window 2 · Students & Evidence**, **Window 3 · Report & Comment** — pick the work, score it, write the report.

1. In the top bar, click ✎ **Add / Edit class**, then ➕ **Add a class**.
2. Name the class, and add the grade, MYP year and subject if you use them.
3. **Master directory** is optional — click 📁 **Browse…** and pick the local folder that will hold this class's assignment folders, or paste a Google Drive folder ID if the class syncs from Drive.
4. Click **Create class**.
5. In Window 2, add students with ➕ **Add student** or import a whole roster file. Check each student's name and email before grading — imported scores are matched to students by them.



The class setup fields and roster appear before grading

Good to know

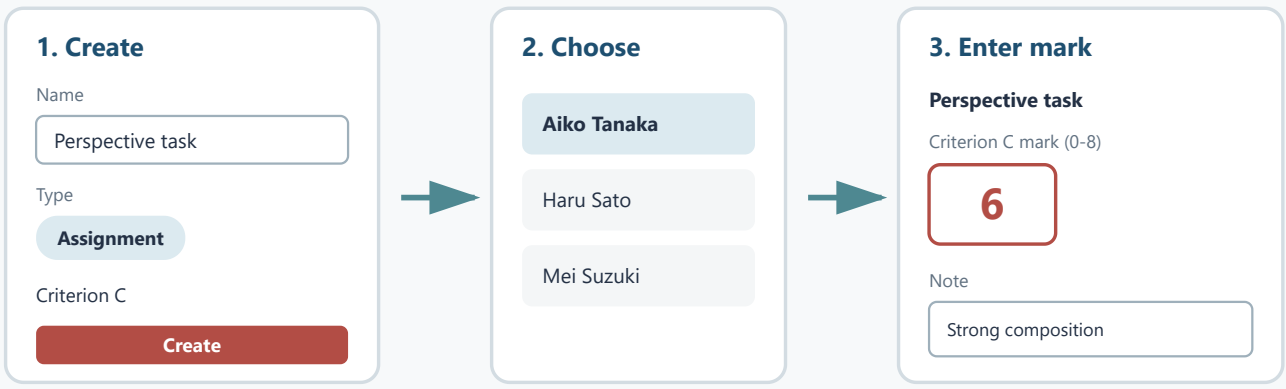
- Criteria A–D are already built in. You choose the criterion when you create each assignment, and every score that feeds a grade stays visible in Window 2.
- The gender field is optional and does exactly one thing: it sets the pronouns used in that student's report comment.
- Column widths and panel heights are draggable, and your layout is remembered on this device only.

> Nothing set here is permanent — reopen ✎ **Add / Edit class** any time to rename the class or change its details.

TASK 4 OF 8

Add an assignment and enter marks

1. Choose the class and term in the top bar.
2. In Window 1, click ➕ **Add assignment / exam**.
3. Enter a name and date, keep **Assignment** selected, pick criterion A, B, C or D, then click **Create**.
4. Click a student in Window 2. In Window 3, find the new assignment and enter a mark from 0 to 8 — with a short note if it's worth remembering why.
5. Work through the class. CAM writes every change into your gradebook as you go; 💾 **Save now** is there for reassurance, not because you have to press it.



Create the assignment, choose a student, and enter the criterion mark

Good to know

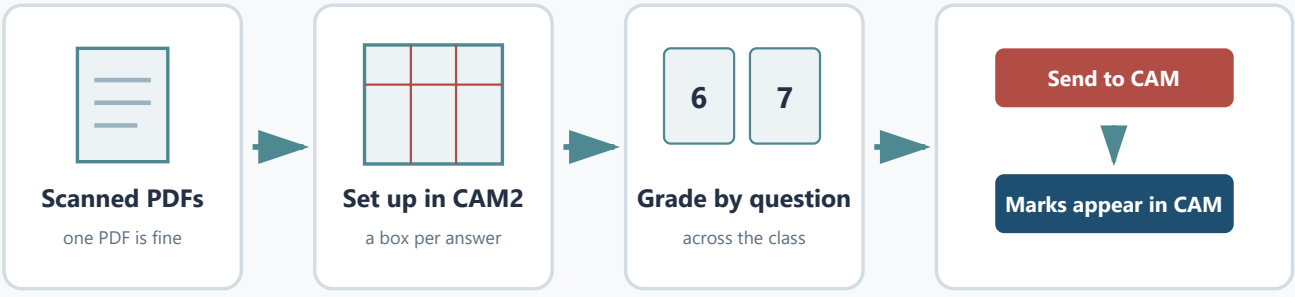
- Typing marks isn't the only way in: Window 1 can import a grade CSV, or watch a folder and ingest new files by itself — scores are matched to students and dated automatically.
- In Window 2 you can exclude a piece that shouldn't count, flag a wrong-assignment upload, or mark work late — the evidence stays visible, and nothing is deleted.
- The weighting method in Window 2 (for example "60/40 Recency") decides how strongly recent work pulls each criterion's suggested grade.

> A new assignment shows as missing for everyone until you enter a mark or switch the assignment off for that student.

TASK 5 OF 8

Grade an exam

1. In Window 1, create the item with ➕ **Add assignment / exam** and mark it as an **Exam**, then click it and choose 🛠 **Exam setup / Grade**. CAM2 Exam Grading opens with your class list already in it.
2. Bring in paper scans or PDFs already exported from slides. Draw a box around each answer on the first paper and choose **Marks** or **Rubric**.
3. Match each paper to a student, then grade one question at a time across the class, with quick comments where they help.
4. In **Review & export**, check the totals and click ✓ **Grading finished — send to CAM**. You can also make the student PDF reports there.
5. Open the exam's **Grades and Analysis** to enter class grades, map rubrics or apply final levels typed in CAM2. In Window 3, click a student's exam pill to see the levels and reference marks and choose one grade per assessed criterion.



Scans are cut into questions, graded in CAM2 and sent back to CAM

Good to know

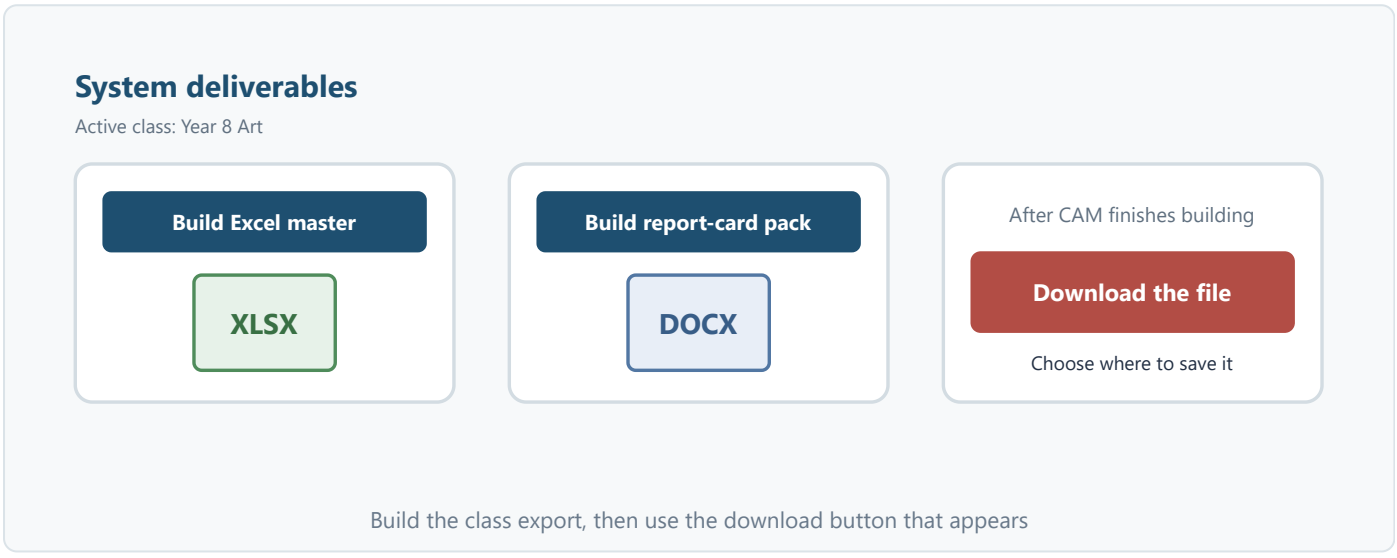
- A box in the wrong place isn't a disaster: ✎ **Adjust this box** while grading fixes it and slices only that question again — every grade you've given stays put.
- CAM leaves new bands blank. Choose each 0–8 grade yourself. For draft work, use an assignment with **Draft — comments only** and grade in the workspace.
- Changed a grade after sending? Click **Send again** in CAM2; grades you already applied in CAM are kept.

> Update every computer that shares the class folder before opening an existing exam. If you see `file_from_newer_version`, update that computer before reopening it.

TASK 6 OF 8

Reports and exports

1. Choose the class and term you're reporting on.
2. In Window 3, review each student's final criterion grades and generate the report comment. With no setup, CAM copies a ready-made prompt for you to paste into any chatbot; add a Claude or Gemini API key in the comment settings and it writes the comment in place.
3. Scroll to **System deliverables**.
4. Click **Build Excel master** for the multi-tab grade workbook, or **Build report-card pack** for one document with a page per student — marks, progression graph, final grades and comment.
5. When the download button appears, click it and save the file. Select one student first if you only need that student's report.



Build the class export, then use the download button that appears

Good to know

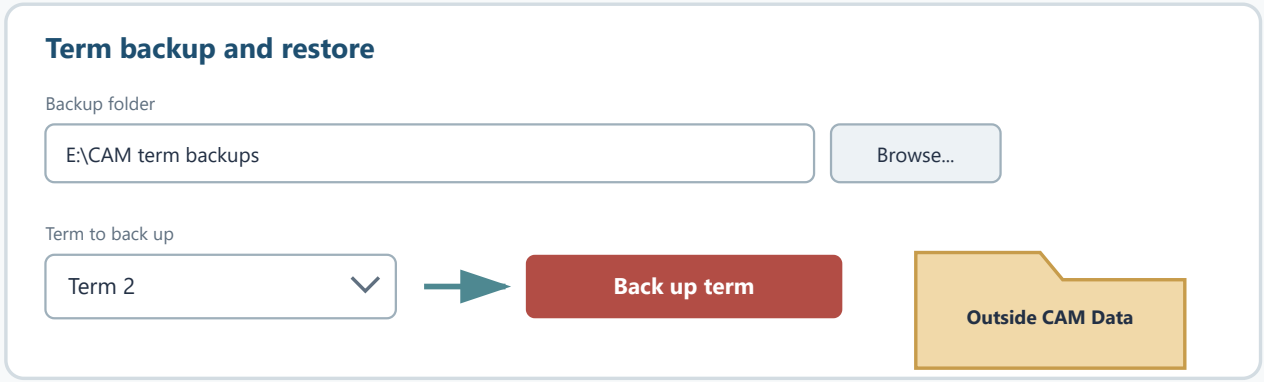
- Exports cover the active class only — switch class in the top bar and build again for the next one.
- If your school reports banded grades on top of the criteria, switch them on in ⚙ **Settings** → **Report-card grades**: MYP Grade (1–7), Effort / English-use and School Grade (1–10) are all off by default, and appear in Window 3 and the reports once enabled.
- Files still sitting in staging pause the export buttons — commit them first.

> A generated comment is a first draft built from your grades. Always read and adjust it before it goes on a report.

TASK 7 OF 8

Back up your term

1. Open ⚙ **Settings** and find 🗄 **Term backup & restore**.
2. Beside the backup folder, click 📁 **Browse…** and choose a folder outside your CAM data folder — a USB stick is ideal for an off-site copy.
3. Choose the term, then click ⬇ **Back up term**.
4. Check the success message and confirm the `cam_term_backup_…` file landed in the folder you chose.



Choose an outside backup folder, select the term, and make the snapshot

Good to know

- A backup holds everything CAM knows about that term — assignments, grades, exam results, comments and effort scores — and it only ever writes outside your database, so backing up can never harm your live data. Make it an end-of-term habit.
- ⬆ **Restore from backup…** is a rescue tool, not an editing tool. It previews exactly what would change, asks you to type a confirmation, and then replaces that whole term — anything you entered after the backup was made is not in the file.
- CAM also keeps automatic `.bak` safety copies beside your database. Leave them alone — they're the last line of defence.

> Keep a second copy somewhere that isn't this computer, and eject a USB drive properly once the backup finishes.

TASK 8 OF 8

When something goes wrong

CAM will not start

Double-click **Start CAM (troubleshooting).bat** instead of the usual launcher. It runs the same CAM with a visible black window — leave it open and read the last message, which usually names the problem. The same details are saved in `logs\cam.log`. If port 8600 is already in use, another CAM is still running: close its window and try again.

CAM cannot find your gradebook

On the welcome screen, click 📁 **Browse...** and choose the folder that contains `acm_database.json`. If CAM is already open, use ⚙ **Settings** → **Custom Database Path** instead. CAM always loads an existing database rather than overwriting it, and shows its class and student counts so you can recognise the right one — never choose Replace unless you truly mean to start over.

You moved to a new laptop

Extract a fresh CAM bundle on the new machine. If your data folder is cloud-synced, sign in and let it finish syncing; otherwise copy the folder across. Start CAM and point 📁 **Browse...** at that folder. Don't copy `local_device_prefs.json` from the old machine — each computer keeps its own paths.

Your gradebook is damaged

Recover the file first: restore `acm_database.json` from your cloud folder's version history, or from the newest `.bak` copy beside it. If one term's detail is still wrong after that, use ⬆ **Restore from backup...** with your end-of-term backup file.

